

originally shared the story. Everybody wins, but your accounts have to be public to be able to use this feature.

USE NEW FEATURES

Instagram continuously updates the platform with new features, which are often geared to increase engagement. Jumping the bandwagon early, and doing it before anyone else, ensures that your feed remains fresh in a highly competitive environment. The best way to do this is to keep a close eye on instagram-pers.com. This is where insta-



Mention sharing on instagram

gram announces all the new features just before they roll out. Being among the first to use a feature as soon as it launches can get you a lot of traction.

GEOTAGGING IS YOUR FRIEND

Apart from hashtags, geotags are another way to gain visibility for your posts. This allows people to search for content nearby. You need to manually add a geotag for each post, and to do this, you need to allow Instagram to access your locations in your settings. There are some specific locations around the world that have their own geostickers, which appear



The geostickers at Sao Paulo

as an option when you are in these locations. While some of these are city wide, others appear only in specific neighbourhoods. Check for these before posting, to see if you can use them.

THIRD PARTY APPS

The filters on instagram may get staid and boring over time. This is a highly visual platform, and the competition is high to put out something that may not have been seen by others before. This is why it is a good idea to use third party apps for photo and video filters that your followers might not have come across on Instagram. If you want to take it a step further, and get high quality content as well, it is



Ca-mera uses signal processing techniques based on cellular automation to get its unique look

better to process the images through paid applications that have unique, high quality filters, style transfer, or other image manipulation techniques. Hyperspektiv, Nception, Ca-mera, and Cinemagraph are some that we recommend.

CAPITALIZE THE FIRST HOUR

The Instagram algorithm that surfaces posts to your followers is weighted in a way that it prefers relevant, recent content with high amounts of activity. This means that you need to find a way to make people to add comments and like your post within the first hour of you sharing it. One good way to do this is to engage with other profiles having similar interests, just before and after you publish your own post. The idea is that followers of these other profiles will look at your comments, and then hop over to your profile. If they like what they see, the chances of your post showing up in someone's timeline increases. Remember to reply quickly to any comments or questions on your post.

ARCHIVE

Over time, people change and your interests may also change. You might find a new passion or want to start focusing on a particular topic for your instagram account, and not want to start an account from scratch. If you have been using Instagram from the time it launched, there might be a lot of low quality junk towards the bottom of your timeline. There is actually a way to remove some posts from being seen from the public, but keeping them in your account. Tapping on

the hamburger icon on a post gives you the option to 'Archive' a particular post.



Archiving posts will hide them from your timeline

HOST A CONTEST

Contests and giveaways related to your area of interest are an easy way to drum up activity and boost engagement. The contest can be simple lucky draw from a pool of likers and/or followers. More advanced contests can take place over multiple posts/stories, and are even more engaging.

TIME YOUR POSTS

It is extremely important to post consistently and frequently. You have to avoid flooding your followers with too many posts, and at the same time, remember that you should not be inactive for too long. The ideal number of posts is between one to three every day.

INVITE TAGS FROM FOLLOWERS

If you craft content and captions that invite people to tag their friends, say something like, who would you want to do a particular activity with. Then it will reach more people and the sharing can create a snowball effect which spreads your post using the friends of your followers. 